JAMES MCALLISTER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Forward Deployed Engineer with 5 years of hands-on experience deploying and maintaining infrastructure across remote and client-facing environments. Specialise in Linux systems administration, containerised deployments, and troubleshooting production issues under pressure. I've spent the last three years working directly with clients to understand their technical needs and implement reliable solutions that actually stick around.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Forward Deployed Engineer

TechCore Solutions Ltd

techcoresolutions.io

Glasgow, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Deployed and managed Kubernetes clusters across multiple client environments in financial services, reducing deployment time from weeks to days.

Provided hands-on technical support to enterprise clients during critical system migrations, achieving 99.2% uptime across all deployments.

Authored infrastructure-as-code templates using Terraform and Ansible, enabling consistent environment provisioning across five different client sites.

Mentored two junior engineers on containerisation practices and troubleshooting methodologies, resulting in improved ticket resolution times.

Senior Systems Engineer

CloudBridge Infrastructure

cloudbridge.net

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

June 2020 - February 2022

Managed and optimised Linux-based infrastructure for SaaS platforms serving 50+ customers, implementing monitoring solutions that reduced mean-time-to-resolution by 40%.

Designed and implemented disaster recovery procedures using rsync and automated backup scripts, ensuring zero data loss during three critical incidents.

Collaborated with development teams to containerise legacy applications using Docker, reducing staging environment setup time from hours to minutes.

Led infrastructure cost optimisation initiatives that identified and eliminated redundant resources, saving approximately GBP 15,000 annually.

Systems Administrator

Nexus IT Services

nexus-it.co

Glasgow, United Kingdom

August 2019 - May 2020

Provisioned and maintained physical servers and virtual machines across a mixed environment of 200+ systems running CentOS and Ubuntu.

Implemented centralised logging using ELK stack, enabling faster incident investigation and root cause analysis across all production services.

Managed user access controls and implemented security hardening procedures, reducing security incidents by 60% in the first six months.

Documented system architecture and runbooks for 12 critical services, improving knowledge transfer and reducing dependency on individual team members.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Glasgow

Glasgow, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2019

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Systems Administration: Linux (CentOS, Ubuntu, Debian), Windows Server, user and access management

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, CloudFormation), Azure basics

Containerisation: Docker, Kubernetes, Docker Compose

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Ansible, CloudFormation

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

Scripting and Automation: Bash, Python, shell scripting

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, firewalls, iptables, VPN configuration

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, basic administration and backup procedures

Version Control: Git, GitHub

CI/CD: GitLab CI, GitHub Actions basics

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (2021)

Linux Foundation Certified System Administrator (LFCS) (2020)

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

github.com/jamesmcallister/kubernetes-deployment-templates

github.com/jamesmcallister/ansible-infrastructure-automation

github.com/jamesmcallister/bash-monitoring-scripts

github.com/jamesmcallister/terraform-aws-vpc-setup